STAIRLING · E-INVOICING · CUSTOMER GUIDE

How your invoice travels, from your screen to your customer’s

Under the reform, invoices between businesses no longer travel by e-mail or post: they go through an official network. Here, without the jargon, is who does what — and why your SIREN number becomes an address.

This guide covers a feature **built into your sales and purchasing management software**: it works from the **Sales** and **Purchasing** modules you already use. Nothing extra to install, no additional portal — issuing your customer invoices and receiving your supplier invoices stay in the same place.

THE IDEA IN ONE PICTURE

It’s a postal service, gone digital

You write the letter. An approved carrier picks it up. A directory tells it which mailbox to deliver it to. The recipient finds it on their own platform. Three roles, never mixed up.

YOUR TOOL

Your sales and purchasing software (Sales & Purchasing)

Where you work, just as you do today: you enter the invoice, approve it and track its payment. The software converts it to the required legal format, checks that no mandatory information is missing, then hands it over to the carrier. The invoices you receive land in the same place.

THE APPROVED CARRIER

The approved platform (PA)

A platform registered by the French tax authorities — the only kind of operator allowed to deliver an invoice. It checks the invoice, delivers it to your customer’s platform, sends the required data to the tax authorities, and returns every acknowledgement of receipt to you.

THE NATIONAL REGISTER

The business directory

The official phone book of invoicing. Every French company declares one thing in it: *here is my address, and here is the platform that receives my invoices*. That is what lets you send an invoice without ever asking your customer “where should I send it?”.

THE ADDRESS

Your SIREN becomes your delivery address

An invoice needs to know where to go. On this network, the address is neither an e-mail nor a postal address: it is the company’s identification number, preceded by a short code that says what kind of number it is.

0225

THE ADDRESS TYPE

An international code meaning “what follows is a French SIREN”. Always the same, for every French company.

812345678

YOUR COMPANY

Your 9-digit SIREN, the one already printed on your documents. Nothing to create, nothing new to remember.

Why the SIREN? Because it is unique, public and stable. An e-mail address changes with the employee who holds it; the SIREN identifies the company itself, for as long as it exists.

What about your establishments? A company with several sites can route delivery more precisely using the SIRET, the address of each establishment. The principle stays the same: one official number, one mailbox.

Who provides it? Nobody needs to give it to you. You know your customer’s SIREN: you already know how to reach them.

JOURNEY 1 OF 2

You issue an invoice

What you do stays the same: create the invoice, then set it to “Sent”. That single status change triggers everything else, which runs on its own within moments.

YOU

01

You set the invoice to “Sent”

You prepare it as usual. While it is a draft, nothing goes out: switching it to “Sent” is what starts the process.

→

YOUR SOFTWARE

02

Conversion to the legal format

As soon as the status changes, your software converts the invoice into the official format, checks the mandatory information and works out the customer’s address from their SIREN.

→

THE PA

03

Handed to the carrier

The approved platform receives the invoice, checks it in turn and gives it a tracking number.

→

DIRECTORY

04

Finding the recipient

The directory answers: SIREN `812345678` receives its invoices on this platform. It is the network’s switchboard.

→

YOUR CUSTOMER

05

The invoice is delivered

It appears in your customer’s software, ready to be checked and paid. And you receive the acknowledgement of receipt.

You are the one who says “go”

An invoice never leaves without your knowledge. A draft stays with you; only switching it to “Sent” triggers submission to the approved platform. If you would rather choose the moment yourself, your software’s manual send command does the same thing on demand. And an invoice that has already been transmitted is never sent twice: your software checks this before every submission.

TRACKING

You always know where the invoice stands

The network sends back acknowledgements at every step. Your software displays them on the invoice: no more chasing to find out whether it arrived.

Submitted → **Accepted by platform** → **Made available to customer** → **Paid**

If the invoice is rejected

The network turns away an incomplete invoice — a wrong number, missing mandatory information. The reason is shown in plain language on the invoice: you correct it and resend it from your software. Nothing is lost.

If your customer refuses it

A refusal is a business decision, not a technical error: a wrong quantity, a disputed service. It comes back to you with its reason and is handled just as it is today — a new invoice or a credit note.

JOURNEY 2 OF 2

You receive an invoice

The same trip in reverse, using the same directory. Your suppliers have nothing to ask you: your address is public, and it points to your software.

SUPPLIER
01
They issue their invoice
From their own software, addressed to your SIREN. They need nothing else.

→

DIRECTORY
02
Your address is looked up
The network reads there that your invoices must be delivered to your approved platform, the one linked to your software.

→

THE PA
03
Your mailbox
The invoice is delivered and stored there. It is the official drop-off point; you don’t need to check it yourself.

→

YOUR SOFTWARE
04
Automatic collection
Your software checks the mailbox at regular intervals, picks up each new invoice and records it with its supplier, amounts and PDF.

→

YOU
05
It’s in your purchases
You find it in your list of received invoices, ready to check and pay. No data entry, no attachment to go and fetch.

THE SPECIAL CASE

What if my customer isn’t in the directory yet?

Not every company has chosen its platform yet. An address missing from the directory is a mailbox that doesn’t exist yet: the invoice cannot be delivered. Your software tells you *before* sending, not after.

✓ Reachable

On the customer or supplier record, this marker shows that the directory knows their address. You can send them your invoices right away.

⊘ Not listed

The directory doesn’t know them yet. Keep invoicing them as before and check again later: as soon as they join the network, the marker turns green and sending becomes possible.

IN SHORT

What changes for you, and what doesn’t

You keep on

Creating your invoices in your software, tracking your payments, checking what your suppliers bill you. Your job doesn’t change — and neither does your screen.

You no longer have to

E-mail your invoices, chase to find out whether they arrived, re-key a supplier invoice, or log in to yet another portal. Your software and the PA take care of it.

Just one thing to do

Authorise your software, once and for all, to send and collect your invoices through its approved platform, and check that your company is properly registered in the directory. After that, nothing more.

GLOSSARY

Four words to remember

Routing address	A company’s delivery address on the network: the code `0225` followed by its SIREN. It is what the carrier reads to know where to deliver the invoice.
Directory	The national register that links each address to the platform that receives the corresponding invoices. Public, searchable, kept up to date by each company.
Approved platform (PA)	A company registered by the French tax authorities to carry invoices — known in official texts as a “*plateforme de dématérialisation partenaire*” (PDP). The one your software is connected to delivers yours.
Lifecycle	The series of official acknowledgements that mark an invoice’s journey — submitted, accepted by platform, made available, paid, or else rejected or refused. Your software displays them for you.